

Vaughn Lee Edwards Jr.

vj09@icloud.com | 703-851-7927 | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/vaughn-edwards-jr/> | <https://github.com/vledwardsjr> | <https://vledwardsjr.github.io>

SUMMARY

Data Analytics and Computer Science student at James Madison University with hands-on experience building end-to-end analytics platforms using SQL, Power BI, Excel, and R. Currently developing an NLP-based pairwise ML classifier to predict human AI response preference, extending professional LLM evaluation experience from the Handshake AI Research Program. Actively seeking a data analytics or data science internship where I can apply both descriptive and predictive modeling skills to real business problems.

EDUCATION

- **James Madison University** — Rising Junior (Computer Science | Data Analytics) – 3.2 GPA | Est. May 2028
 - *Relevant Coursework:* Introduction to Data, Applied Statistics Using R, Algorithms & Data Structures, Discrete Structures, Calculus I

PROJECTS

- **NBA Player & Team Analytics Dashboard** | PostgreSQL, Excel, Power BI, R, PowerPoint | <https://github.com/vledwardsjr/NBA-Analytics-Project> | June 2026
 - Designed a normalized PostgreSQL database covering 6 NBA seasons of player and team statistics, with all scoring logic built in SQL
 - Built a percentile-based composite scoring system for player/team performance; diagnosed and fixed a critical formula flaw
 - Developed a custom award framework (MVP, DPOY, OPOY + 5 fictional awards); cut 4 categories after identifying small-sample bias
 - Delivered 7 Power BI dashboards, an R methodology report, and a stakeholder deck; published complete project to GitHub
- **LLM Response Preference Predictor** | Python, scikit-learn, NLP, Streamlit | <https://github.com/vledwardsjr/LLM-Response-Preference-Project> | In Progress — Est. July 2025
 - Building a pairwise classification model on Chatbot Arena (LMSYS) dataset to predict human AI response preference; project motivated by professional LLM evaluation experience at Handshake AI Research Program
 - Engineering NLP feature pipeline quantifying structural flow and specificity/vagueness as computable numeric difference scores between paired responses
 - Compared Logistic Regression baseline against Random Forest/XGBoost; evaluated on precision, recall, and ROC-AUC with feature importance and error analysis identifying where automated judgment diverges from human raters
 - Delivered interactive Streamlit demo and findings report; architecture directly mirrors real-world RLHF pipelines used to train production LLMs
- **NYC Jobs Market Analysis Dashboard** | Excel | <https://github.com/vledwardsjr/nyc-jobs-excel-dashboard> | February 2026
 - Designed an interactive data dashboard in Excel using Power Query and PivotTables to analyze job market trends
 - Performed data cleaning and transformation on datasets with 1,000+ records
 - Conducted exploratory data analysis across multiple variables to identify salary and hiring trends
 - Created dynamic visualizations to communicate insights and support data-driven decision making

SKILLS

- **Programming & Data Tools:** Python (pandas, scikit-learn, NLP feature engineering, scripting) | SQL (window functions, CTEs, layered view architecture, relational database design) | Excel (PivotTables, Power Query, advanced formulas, data cleaning) | Tableau (dashboards, data visualization) | Power BI (dashboard development, DAX) | R (R Markdown, data analysis, technical reporting) | Streamlit (interactive ML demos)
- **Data Analytics & Methods:** Data Cleaning & Transformation (ETL concepts) | Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) | Machine Learning (classification, pairwise modeling, feature importance, error analysis) | NLP & Text Feature Engineering | Model Evaluation (precision, recall, ROC-AUC) | Data Visualization & Dashboarding | KPI Development & Performance Metrics | Statistical Analysis (regression, distributions) | Data Modeling (Dimensional/Relational Modeling)
- **Other Tools:** Git & GitHub (version control) | Jupyter Notebook | Relational Database Design | Data Entry & Validation | POS & Inventory Systems
- **Core Competencies:** Analytical Thinking & Problem Solving | Data Interpretation & Communication | Attention to Detail | Cross-Functional Collaboration

CERTIFICATIONS

- IBM Intro to Data Analytics (2025) | Excel for Data Analytics (2025) | SQL for Data Analytics (2025) | SQL+ for Data Analytics (2026) | Power BI for Data Analytics (2026) | CompTIA IT Fundamentals (ITF+) | IC3 GS6 Level 1 & Level 2
- *Global Career Accelerator* — Data Analysis (Excel) (Mar 2026) | Data Visualization (Tableau) (May 2026) | AI Professional Skills (May 2026) | Intercultural Skills (May 2026)

WORK/LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

- **Fit Right Kid's Shoes Inventory Specialist (September 2022 - August 2024)**
 - Managed and tracked inventory data across 100+ items using POS systems
 - Ensured data accuracy through validation and consistent data entry processes
 - Supported inventory analytics by organizing and updating product records
- **Fit Right Kid's Shoes Front Desk & Customer Data Specialist (November 2024 - January 2026)**
 - Maintained and validated customer data using POS and scheduling systems
 - Ensured data accuracy and consistency for operational efficiency
 - Collaborated with team members to improve data reliability in scheduling workflows
- **Bridgly (Early-Stage Startup) — Co-Founder & Operations Lead**
 - Led data validation and organization of operational datasets to ensure accuracy and usability
 - Coordinated workflows and managed data processes to support platform functionality
 - Contributed to early-stage data structuring and process optimization
- **Handshake AI Research Program — AI Trainer (February 2025 - May 2026)**
 - Evaluated large language model outputs using structured evaluation frameworks to assess accuracy and reasoning quality
 - Analyzed response patterns across multiple prompts to identify inconsistencies and improve model performance
 - Applied analytical thinking and attention to detail in high-volume evaluation workflows

INTERESTS

NBA & Sports Analytics | Fitness & Weightlifting | Exploring Data Projects and Visualization | AI/ML technology